The Boscowitz-Bloch Family History

(prepared by Emily Buckman Good-last edited 4-1-2026)

NOTES: Because dates provided come from various sources, I have found some discrepancies, even when official documents were consulted. Corrections are welcomed. This file is presented mainly to share photographs of our ancestors and limited information on their children. Please refer to the extensive family trees for more complete lists of descendants. Since Sophie was my great grandmother, I have additional photographs and documents to share below.

Minna Boscowitz (August 13, 1838 – July 8, 1878) married on January 21 1863, **Abraham Hirsch Bloch** (1826 – November 24, 1887). *Information from Allan Pinkus*: Abraham and Minna both came from the small town of Floss in eastern Bavaria near the Czech border. (Abraham was actually born in a smaller town some 10 km away as his father was one of the first Jews of Floss to buy an agricultural patch. It had been forbidden before that.) Minna was one of eight children. Four of her brothers immigrated to Oregon, only one of which survived young adulthood and had family. Her other siblings remained in Floss and married, had children.

Abraham Bloch

Minna Boscowitz

Abraham and Minna lived in Floss and at the time their daughter Sophie was born in 1872; this was their house.

Minna gave birth to seven children. The youngest, Julius, died in his first year (April 11, 1874 - Feb 11, 1875). The other six siblings were: Henriette/Jette, Heinrich, Anton, Joseph, Arnold, and Sophie. Minna died in 1878. Abraham then married **Carolina Weinschenk**. Carolina, while single, had moved to Georgia in America to be the housekeeper for her two bachelor brothers. When they married, Carolina returned to Germany and eventually married Abraham. Carolina became stepmother to the six siblings. Sophie's daughter Minnie (my grandmother) remembers her step-grandmother playing American folk songs on the piano.

Carolina at different ages

The Bloch Siblings

Henriette/Jette Bloch

(July 6, 1864 – November 1, 1938)

Jette Lipp (nee Henriette Bloch, (July 6, 1864 – Nov 1, 1938). Middle photo may be around time of marriage in 1887? Photo on right, c. 1924)

On March 12, 1887, Henriette/Jette married **Salomon Lipp** (March 5, 1862 – December 20, 1932).

They had three daughters: Wilhelmine/Mina, Mathilda/Tilde and Else. In 1936 Widow Jette moved in with Mina and Willi Engelbert.

Wilhelmine/Mina Lipp (March 26, 1888 – October 12, 1942 Holocaust) married **Willi Engelbert** (Dec. 18, 1874 – March 16, 1942). They lived in Kassel and had two daughters:

Elfriede (Friedl) Engelbert (August 23, 1911 – August 1, 1986) Immigrated to Palestine in 1935. Married Alex Schwarz.

Edit Engelbert (June 6, 1916 - August 4, 2012 in Ashkelon) Immigrated to Palestine in 1937. Married Moshe Dorot (April 18, 1915 – d. 1982)

Identity papers photographs for Mina and Willi.

Among my grandparents' letters was this correspondence from Willi, who was desperately trying to find a way to safety. Only the daughters were able to achieve that end.

February 5, 1939
Hohenstorstr. 7, Kassel

My Dear Ones,

We take courage to write to you about the extraordinarily bad situation in which we find ourselves. I will briefly describe the situation to you. I had to file for bankruptcy in August. Only the thought that I am not the one who has paid for a lot of business mistakes and only the thought that there are still thousands like me who were definitely as competent or incompetent as me kept me going. Until December I got daily support from the crowd and didn't need any people. Now our children have requested us and we hope, and the children definitely believe, to be there for the next certificate [visa] distribution. At the moment we live from the sale of individual pieces of furniture, and it cannot go on like this. Because we wanted to accumulate this income to cover freight (we should bring bedroom and kitchen) and travel expenses from this amount. And that works even when everything is sold, then we will have that amount. But if we continue to draw on it, one day when the certificate arrives, we will be left without means of travel and that would be bad. My friends tell me that I should cast off the false shame and turn to friends and relatives who are in a far better situation than I am. That's the situation. If it should be possible for you, I know you are no longer in the same position as before, I ask you to help me get through these few months.

I don't need to go on with any further words, I know if you can do it.

I heard from Else that you are in good health, and in this sense, everything is fine with us too. Mina can't bring herself to write to you, that's why I do.

With best regards, your Willi

Address all shipments to Mina Engelbert, as my bankruptcy is still pending. Do not forget!!

Mathilda/Tilde Lipp (April 8, 1889 – d. 1942 Holocaust) married on November 11, 1911, **Siegfried Schwager** (Aug. 23, 1878 – March 20, 1942 Holocaust). They had one daughter:

Thea Schwager (July 1916 – 1942 Holocaust)

My grandmother Minnie, a first cousin to the Lipp daughters, sought to get information after the war about the fate of the Schwagers and received the following letters (translated from German). Note: actual concentration camp identified varies from these letters and what is recorded at Yad Vashem.

From: Dr. Julius Spanier, München
November 30, 1947

Dear Mr. Heiman!

On your request, I can give you detailed information, as I have given the Schwager family medical advice many times and therefore knew them well.

Siegfried Schwager, his wife and daughter Thea came to the Theresienstadt camp in June 1942, where I was with my wife for over 3 years. Siegfried died there and his wife and daughter came to Auschwitz in autumn 1943 and were gassed there.

Max Schwager and Mrs. Berta went to Riga on November 20, 1941. However, this transport never came to Riga but was shot in a forest in front of Riga (there were 1,000 people). We have precise information about this from a security guard who had to accompany the transport.

Under these circumstances, it is quite understandable that you have not received any messages from these relatives so far.

I would like to send greetings to Max Uhlfelder.

Best regards from yours, [Julius]

From: Max Uhlfelder/Uhlfelder Trading Company
154 Nassau St, New York, NY 7
March 4, 1948

Dear Mrs. Heiman:

Thank you for your letter of February 26th. Unfortunately, it contains very sad news. But it had been clear to me for a long time that the Schwagers were no longer alive. Friedl was already very weak when I was still in Munich, after all, he died a natural death. On the other hand, it is even more terrible what Tilda and Thea had to endure, because I am well aware of the SS methods. But there is no point in lamenting about it, we can only keep them in our memory.

I also lost my sister as you did your [family]. *They came to Riga and were probably in the same transport. So far, I have not been able to get accurate information about it, despite asking Munich friends for information. But I've known for a long time that they are no longer alive.*

When he moved to Munich, Max Schwager bought a very nice family home in Schwabing. Friedl last lived with him. Now the law for reparation has appeared and it would be time to make claims. These must be submitted by December. I advise you to communicate with the nieces of Schwager and to make claims in any case.

I hope to hear again and best regards from my friends. Max Uhlfelder

Else Lipp (Dec. 13. 1891 – d. 1942 Holocaust) married July 16, 1913 **Ernst Lewy/Levy** (Dec 14, 1877 – July 10, 1939). They had a daughter and son:

Herta (Hannah) Lewy (Feb. 2, 1919 – January 1993). Married Nov 4, 1941/Divorced Erich Weiler (1909-1983), immigrated to US. Married John Dodd in 1973

Gustav Walter Lewy (April 14, 1928 – 1942 Holocaust with mother)

Family portrait with most of the immediate family, circa 1920. Since the little girls appear similar in age, they are most likely Edit Engelbert and Thea Schwager, the only two cousins with similar birth years (1916 and 1917). Left to right: Willi and Mina Engelbert, Edit, Tilde Schwager, Solomon, Thea, Jette and Else. Missing from this portrait are the Engelberts' older daughter Elfriede, who would have been about 9 years old, Tilde's husband Siegfried, and Else's husband Ernst Lewy and daughter Herta/Hanni born in 1919. Their son Gustav was not born until 1928.

Heinrich Bloch

(September 10, 1865 – 1924)

Married **Fanny Bruell** (October 12, 1874 - ?) Had one daughter:

Martha Bloch (March 18, 1904 – August 2, 1994) married **Siegfried (Freidel) Hauschild** (May 4, 1894 - 1958). Immigrated to Kenya, and in 1960s immigrated to Australia. They had a daughter and son:

Alice Therese Hauschild (March 9, 1926 – August 26, 1986) married Alexander Friedrich Hermann (March 28, 1918 – December 8, 1994)

Henry Hauschild (c. 1932 – September 3, 2021) married June Hendry

Fanny and Heinrich

Martha

The Hauschild story of immigration as recounted by my mother, Ursula Heiman Buckman: Fanny or Martha met and cared for the mother of Henry Morgenthau when she took ill while she was visiting Germany. Morgenthau was the US Secretary of the Treasury during the Roosevelt administration. With the rise of the Nazis, Martha and Siegfried Hauschild appealed to the Morgenthaus for help in getting visas out of Germany. They were given documents so they could immigrate to Kenya, where they settled and ran a plantation. The Mau-Mau rebellion years made life very difficult; as well, Siegfried had died suddenly. Martha and her children once again were uprooted and with their British citizenship resettled in Australia where they remained the rest of their lives.

Anton Bloch

(December 19, 1866 – May 17, 1943 Theresienstadt)

Anton immigrated to the US c. 1885, and married **Bertha Bomeisler** (January 5, 1867 – 1920) in 1888, in Philadelphia. He moved his family back to Germany prior to WWI.

This photo was taken while Anton lived in New York City.

Anton and Bertha had two children:

Adolf Bloch (February 2, 1889 Philadelphia - December 3, 1938).
Unmarried, was an advocate/attorney, injured in WWI.

Minnie Bloch (April 15, 1891 New York City - 1937) married Jan 11, 1922, Theodor Oppenheimer (January 11, 1878 - February 21, 1929). They had two sons:

Bernd Oppenheimer (March 14, 1923 - 1945 Auschwitz, after Russian offensive)

Bruno (Baruch) Oppenheimer (May 24, 1925 - May 13, 2000). Married Betty (Batya) Cohen (October 6, 1921 - January 23, 2006) Immigrated to Israel.

Joseph Bloch

(September 24, 1868 – September 9, 1945)

Married **Louise Silberstein** (November 20, 1878 – September 30, 1976). Immigrated to London. They had two children: Alfred and Meta.

Louise and Josef

Meta and Alfred

Alfred Bloch (August 1, 1904 - May 11, 1979 London), never married, Louise lived with him.

Meta Bloch (November 19, 1906 - February 13, 1990) married **Alfred Bayer** (June 23, 1899 - June 6, 1972). They immigrated to Sydney, Australia. They had one daughter:

Marianne Bayer (August 16, 1930 - August 4, 2003) married Jack Krygier

Alfred and his mother Louise in London, 1961

Arnold Bloch
(February 24, 1871 - March 17, 1943)
Unmarried

Sophie Bloch
(April 15, 1872 – November 2, 1943 Theresienstadt)

Married on June 28, 1898, **Julius Gustav Jonas** (August 14, 1868 – September 26, 1938). They had 2 daughters:

- **Minnie Jonas** (April 3, 1899 – September 12, 1990) married Herman Heiman (April 14, 1898 – Feb 23, 1977). They had a son and daughter:
  - **Udo Gunther Heiman** (March 1, 1924), married Lore Blake (December 11, 1926 - 2004)
  - **Ursula Renate Heiman** (April 18, 1926 – November 2, 2019) married Erwin Buckman (December 21, 1911 – October 19, 1996)
- **Paula Jonas** (January 13, 1907, lived three days)

Sophie and Julius lived at Ritterstrasse 7, Arnstadt/Thüringen. The house was built in 1751 and was part of a palace complex. This photo is from 1912/1913 and shows Julius with daughter Minnie standing to the left.

Anton Bloch standing. Seated left to right: Udo, Ursula, grandparents Sophie and Julius Jonas c 1932

This birthday poem was written by Sophie to her daughter Minnie after Minnie and family immigrated to America in 1939. Sophie, suffering from a broken hip and without a visa, had to remain behind. Despite threats from the Nazis, Franzi Gerner (who was not Jewish, worked for the Heimanns but came to be a sister to Minnie) went as often as she could to care for Sophie. Sophie and Anton were rounded up by the Nazis along with all the remaining Jews in Anstadt and eventually sent to Theresienstadt where they perished.

For the April 3, 1940 birthday of my dear Minnie as a little present

The way between us is so very far,
But we are all the more connected because of it
Our thoughts easily reach each other
With a lightness in a few seconds.
Not weather not storms nor Manon's violent blowing
Who may make the way hard
They flew not short, not over, but straight ahead
We know where they belong.
From heart to heart it goes back and forth
In the most loving sentiments.
Only the poet and singer alone can do it
To bind your rhyme in words.
But no, they are still not enough,
To reproduce them in their size,
For the mother to her child
That happens only once in a lifetime
Deeply embedded deep in the heart
It is kept there forever.
Nothing in the world can destroy it
The mother's love will always prevail.

Attempts were made to get a visa for Sophie throughout the war. The following is one of the letters sent in 1945 to the Hebrew Sheltering and Immigrant Aid Society.

Minnie Heiman
Herman Heiman
R.D.1, Ocean Ave.
Lakewood N.J.

January 27,1945

Statement.

To whom it may concern:

The applicant Mrs. Sophie Jonas, nee Bloch, now in Theresienstadt, Checho-Slovakia, born in Floss, Bavaria, Germany on April 15,1872, is our mother resp. mother in law.

She wanted to come to us to America as soon as we were settled. We have now since September 1940 a good existence in operating a poultry farm.

It is, of course, our sincerest wish to have our mother here on our farm, where she could live as a helpful member of the family.

She is quite alone. Her husband, our father resp. father in law, died 7 years ago, and I, Minnie Heiman am the only child of her.

Our mother has only one thought: to be reunited with us.

We have one son and one daughter. Our boy, 21 years old, is serving with the U.S.A. Army since April 1943 and is now overseas in combat. Our daughter Ursula is 18 years old and will graduate in June 1945 at the Point Pleasant Beach High School. After that time she will become secretary and ~~the~~ support herself.
We shall have then no more dependents.

We feel confident that the applicant will be a useful member of the community and will make a good citizen.
Already her mother Mrs. Bloch lived a long time in U.S.A. (about 30 years), before she went back to Europe for marriage.

The application was approved, but Sophie had already perished.

Form I-101
U. S. DEPARTMENT OF JUSTICE
Immigration and Naturalization Service
(Rev. 10-26-44)

Philadelphia 2, Pa.

Date April 12, 1945
File No. V-319332
V/F&PXU

Jonas

NOTICE OF APPROVAL OF PETITION FOR ISSUANCE OF IMMIGRATION VISA

Your petition for issuance of immigration visa has been approved and forwarded to the Department of State for appropriate disposition. If you desire further information, it is suggested that you communicate with the Visa Division, Department of State, Washington 25, D. C.

GPO 16—42677-1

Joseph Savorth

Assistant Commissioner for Adjudications.

Mrs. Minnie J. Heiman
R. D. #1
Lakewood, New Jersey